START FROM SCRATCH / HYPER-PACED LEARNING

Week 3: RAG readiness and build sprint

Ground the model with trusted knowledge, then build and present a usable solution together in one focused hackathon-style day.

WHAT YOU ALREADY HAVE

You can make a Model Call

Your SRE Assistant can receive an incident, send instructions to a model, and return a useful first response. Now it needs evidence it can trust.

THIS WEEK'S PLAN

Add retrieval before generation

Understand RAG, retrieval, and reranking. Prepare independently, align as a team, and build a grounded solution in the one-day sprint.

RED FLAGS / TESTING

Do not mistake retrieval for truth

Test whether the right material is retrieved, whether answers stay grounded in it, and how the system responds when evidence is missing or conflicting.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A grounded SRE Assistant

Your solution retrieves relevant runbook knowledge, uses it to improve the SRE guidance, and shows a clear demo of the evidence and final recommendation.

The AI can now do more than answer from general knowledge: it can read the right internal information before it responds.

WEEK 3 LEARNING PACK

RAG: Learn the concept before you build

Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) helps an AI system retrieve relevant information from a knowledge source and use it to produce a grounded response.

Suggested learning sequence

1. RAG fundamentals

A beginner-friendly walkthrough of the core RAG idea and pipeline.

Open resource

2. RAG crash course

Build a broad mental model before the team starts making technical choices.

Open resource

3. RAG types and architectures

Explore the range of RAG patterns and the trade-offs behind choosing one.

Open resource

4. Retrieval and reranking

Understand how systems find relevant sources, use keyword, vector, or hybrid search, and improve results through reranking.

Open resource

5. Additional RAG video

Use this as an additional perspective during preparation or when the team needs a refresher.

Open resource

What success looks like

By the end of the day, your team should have:

A working solution, a clear explanation of its design, evidence of team collaboration, and a focused presentation ready for a 5-minute demo plus 10-minute discussion.

Bring curiosity, preparation, and a willingness to test your ideas. The goal is not only to ship a prototype - it is to learn how thoughtful teams turn a concept into a credible solution.